



What is philosophy? Philosophers at the table



Class video: <https://youtu.be/XYjuWoKe5qI>

The code leads to the video.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Before you start

1. Without looking at anything: what is philosophy? Answer in one sentence.
2. **At the end of the class.** Reread your sentence. Which of the seven is it most like? Would you change it? If you do, what reason made you change it?

While you watch the video

1. What are the four features of philosophy?
2. What did Socrates compare himself to, and why?

3. What sentence does Aristotle's *Metaphysics* begin with?
4. What two kinds of knowledge does Thomas Aquinas distinguish at the start of the *Summa Theologiae*?
5. **Your prediction.** If the whole of philosophy were a tree, what would be in the roots? And what fruit would it bear?
6. **Stop and think.** Why do Kant's first three questions lead to the fourth?
7. Which word is the key to Marx's sentence about philosophers?
8. For María Zambrano, how do philosophy and poetry differ?
9. What do Confucius and Socrates have in common?

The table

Philosopher	For them, philosophy is...
Socrates	
Aristotle	
Thomas Aquinas	
Descartes	

Philosopher	For them, philosophy is...
Kant	
Marx	
María Zambrano	

What they share:

Where they disagree:

Seven questions for you

Underline the one that made you most uncomfortable. That is your question.

1. Why do you live the way you live? Who is your gadfly, the one who wakes you up with uncomfortable questions?
2. What would you like to know even if it were no use to you at all?
3. How far does your reason go? Is there something you believe without being able to prove it?
4. What roots does what you think rest on? Have you ever examined them?
5. What can you know? What ought you to do? What may you hope? What kind of being are you?
6. Is there something you know is wrong and you leave it as it is? Why?

7. What have you found without looking for it? And what are you really looking for?

Your eighth chair

For you, what is philosophy?

- I sit with... (or my own answer):
- My reason:
- The objection ... would make:
- My reply to that objection:

Practice

1. Choose two at the table who clash: what would one say to the other?
2. Your eighth chair, in five lines: your answer, a reason and the objection one of the seven would make, with your reply to it.
3. Ask someone at home what they think philosophy is. Which of the seven is it like? Which feature is missing?

Keep thinking

Seven answers in more than twenty centuries. What would the 21st century's be? What should philosophy be in your time?

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